JANDÉ · ONCE UPON A TIME · ACTION RPG

The Cast

Every character that ships in the RPG, pulled straight out of the game’s own atlases.

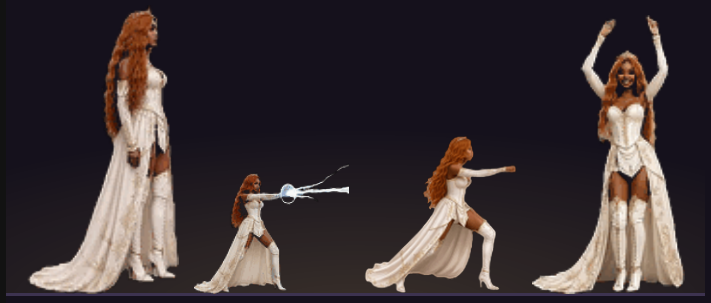
Nothing on this page was redrawn or described from memory. Each figure is the shipped sprite, cut from the file the game loads at runtime, and every number beside it was read out of the source or measured off the pixels.

1	6	9	150	117
HEROINE	FOE TYPES	BOSSES	HERO FRAMES	VILLAIN CELLS

THE HEROINE

Jandé

Thirteen rendered animation sheets — ten side-view for the RPG, three back-view for Royal Runner. The side art faces **right**; left is a mirror. She fights with her voice, so every verb in the game is a musical one.



idle attack belt dance

HER VOCABULARY

Resonance	the resource everything spends
Grace Notes	the collectibles strung across every jump
Mic Strike	the melee
Sound Wave	the projectile
Hold Note	the block
Refrain	she heals by singing
Belt	the magic strike
Downbeat	the aerial pogo

SLOT	FRAMES	RATE	WHAT IT IS
idle	6	6.7 fps	Breath and shift
run	8	15 fps	2.36 body-heights per cycle
jump	6	8.6 fps	Held 7 each across 44 frames of airtime
attack	8	30 fps	Mic Strike — the fastest sheet in the game
dash	5	15 fps	Ground dash, on a cooldown
block	3	10 fps	Hold Note — the guard
dance	6	10 fps	Idle flourish and the victory beat
refrain	6	10 fps	Refrain — the heal
belt	5	15 fps	Belt — the magic strike
downstrike	4	15 fps	Downbeat — the aerial pogo
bkrun	25	–	Back view, Royal Runner
bkjump	25	–	Back view, Royal Runner
bkslide	25	–	Back view, Royal Runner

SIX TYPES · 36 PAINTED CELLS

The Foe Roster

They are introduced on a schedule, not all at once — the stage you first meet one is the real information here. All six share a single 52×58 collider anchored at the feet; the drawn size differs per type so the painting reads at speed. Each bleeds what it is made of, and only flesh bleeds red.



ENTERS STAGE 1 · ONCE UPON A PAGE

Thorn Goblin

Ground, ledge-guarded · 112×124 px · bleeds green sap

A troll on the floor. Patrols at 0.7, then accelerates to 1.9 the moment she is inside 340px. Ledge-guarded, so it stops at the brink of a pit rather than gliding across it.



ENTERS STAGE 2 · FIRST LIGHT MEADOW

Cursed Raven

Flyer · 100×110 px · bleeds smoke

Bobs on a slow sine at its hover line, then dives to her exact height the moment she is inside 170px. Closes at 1.6.



ENTERS STAGE 4 · THE ROSE WALTZ

Nightshade Sprite

Flyer | 100×110 px | bleeds violet ichor

Hovers wide and out of reach on a 46px swing, then darts. The dash window is 40 frames in every 150 and it crosses at 3.4 — more than double the raven.

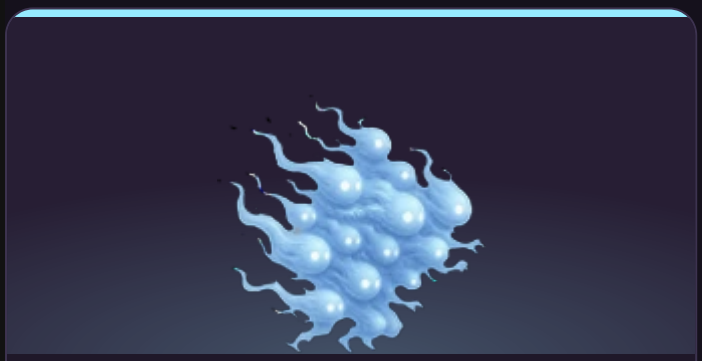


ENTERS STAGE 5 · THE MIRROR LAKE

Bramble Knight

Ground, ledge-guarded | 138×152 px | bleeds green sap

The heaviest thing on the floor and the largest sprite in the set. Tops out at 1.15 with 0.92 inertia, so it accelerates and turns slowly and every approach is telegraphed.

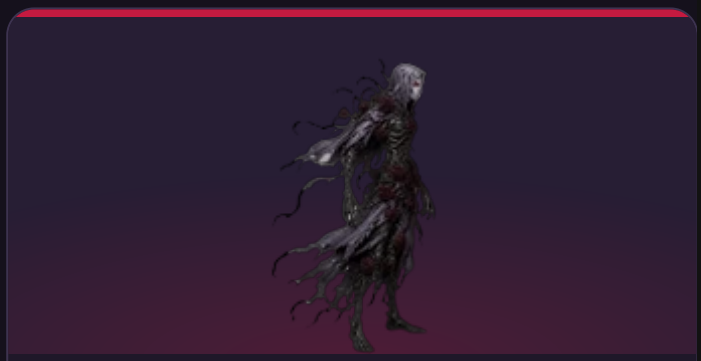


ENTERS STAGE 6 · THE WISHING GLADE

Wisp Swarm

Flyer | 88×96 px | bleeds pale light

The smallest, and the quickest to change its mind. Weaves on a 0.09 sine while closing, and inside 150px it swarms her head outright.



ENTERS STAGE 8 · THE SKY GARDENS

Rose Wraith

Flyer | 124×138 px | bleeds red

The elite. Homes from 420px away, further than anything else in the game can see, and never stops — but only at 1.05. It is the one flyer that bleeds red.

NINE STAGES, NINE VILLAINS

The Nine

Each stage ends the same way: a locked gate, a sealed arena, and a villain that belongs to nowhere else. Four idle frames cycle through the fight; five defeat frames play on the kill, under slow motion, a KO spotlight and a push-in. HP is shown at normal difficulty — ×1.4 on Hard, ×0.7 on Easy.



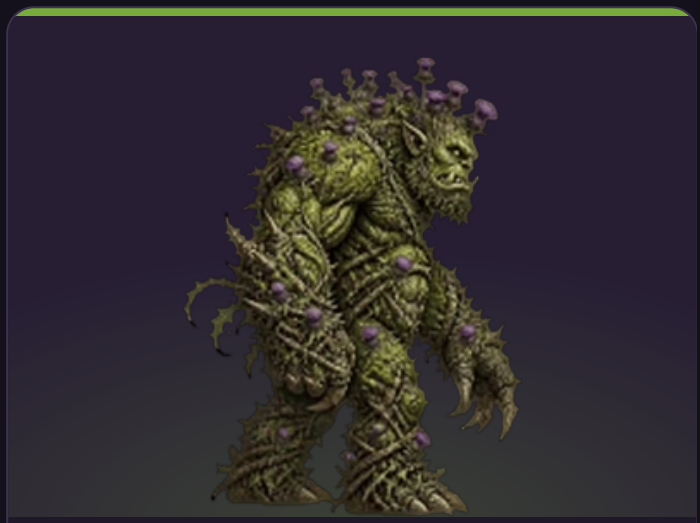
STAGE 1 · ONCE UPON A PAGE

Ink Warden

7 HP · bleeds ink

The library’s keeper, and the first thing that tells her this story has a guard.

Torn pages drift upward while ink motes fall through them.



STAGE 2 · FIRST LIGHT MEADOW

Thistle Ogre

9 HP · bleeds sap

A meadow brute. Blunt, heavy, and the first boss that really hits back.

Kicked-up dust and floating thistle seed.



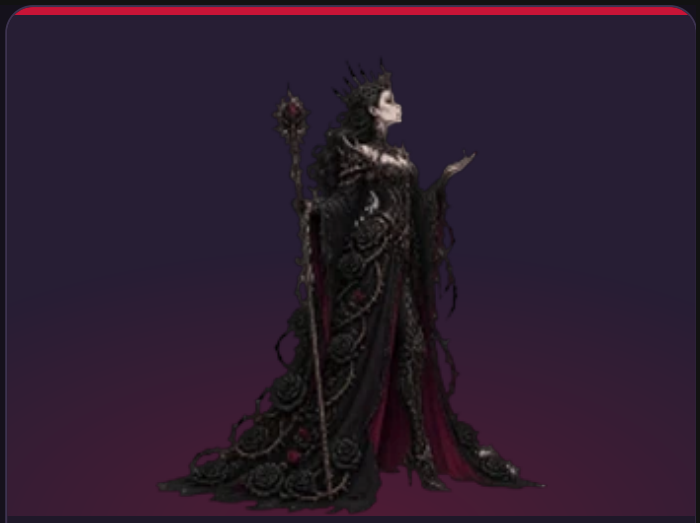
STAGE 3 · THE PETAL MILE

Blossom Revenant

11 HP · Airborne · bleeds petals

Never touches the ground, so it drifts and shoots where the others jump and slam.

A wraith's veil of petals, all held in orbit.



STAGE 4 · THE ROSE WALTZ

Thorn Queen

13 HP · bleeds red

Humanoid, and she bleeds red — the rule across the whole cast is that only flesh does.

Rose-and-thorn motes coiling counter-clockwise.



STAGE 5 · THE MIRROR LAKE

Lake Wraith

15 HP · Airborne · bleeds water

Airborne and serpentine: a 58px vertical sway that couples into its horizontal glide.

Water beads trailing the serpentine glide, head to tail.



STAGE 6 · THE WISHING GLADE

Toadstool Warlock

17 HP · bleeds spores

The glade's caster. Everything it throws at her is alive.

A low fog bank with a spore cloud rising out of it.



STAGE 7 · THE GOLDEN HOUR

Scarecrow King

19 HP · bleeds straw

Stuffed and crowned. The only boss whose atmosphere is other animals.

Crows wheel overhead as straw scatters off him.



STAGE 8 · THE SKY GARDENS

Storm Titan

21 HP · bleeds storm-light

Has its own attack table, charge-heavy, because the gusts carry it across the arena.

Churning cloud haze with lightning strobing inside it.



STAGE 9 · HER ENCORE

The Groom Who Lied

28 HP · bleeds red

The finale. 28 HP, a third again the Storm Titan. The story’s real antagonist — and he bleeds red.

Dark embers rising off a broken vow.

FOUND WHILE MAKING THIS PAGE

The Groom was dying backwards

Laying all 81 villain cells out side by side made something visible that playing never did. Across every other boss, the defeat run drops its weight down the cell and loses substance — the centre of mass travels `+14.6px` on the Ink Warden and `+111.4px` on the Storm Titan, shedding up to `43` points of coverage.

Row nine alone travelled the other way: `−20.7px` upward, `+4.9` points *gained*. Measured a second way, by silhouette overlap against each villain's own standing pose, the other eight finish least like themselves and the Groom finishes *most* like himself (`0.505`, the highest of his five).

So on the climax of the whole game, the Groom collapsed into frame and then stood back up. His five cells were authored in reverse and it shipped that way. The art was always right; only the order was wrong, and it now plays from the last cell to the first. He is struck, he burns, he falls.

How this was put together. Portraits are cut from `web/e3bc36ab1807.webp` (the foe atlas, 4896×152, cells 136×152) and `web/78f95835ae52.webp` (the boss atlas, 1800×2520, cells 200×280), both shipped with the game. Behaviour, speeds, hit boxes, HP and bleed colours were read out of `index.html`. Coverage, centroids and silhouette overlap were measured off the pixels.

An older enemy set — cupids, gargoyles, golems and the rest — is still in the file but is never reached: the function that spawns it has no callers. It is not part of the cast and is not shown here.